The 6:15

FRIDAY · OCTOBER 30, 2026 NO. 33

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Fri 10/30 (today)	Knicks at 76ers, 7:30p ET.
Sat 10/31	Northwestern at Oregon, Eugene — first-ever meeting; kickoff ~3:30p ET per a sportsbook listing **(unconfirmed vs. primary source)**. OPEC+ meets; Oct. 4 decision held Nov. output flat at 31.01M bpd, no change signaled for this round.
Tue 11/3	Midterm elections — House and Senate majorities both in play, four days out.
Wed 11/5	Weekly jobless claims (week ended Nov. 1), 8:30a ET.

No confirmed frontier AI release, major rocket launch, VC mega-round, or political primary surfaced this run. Correction: yesterday's calendar had the 76ers game dated Saturday — it tips tonight.

METRICS · ~6:15A ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	$117.28 (+2.09%) / $104.08 (+2.04%) — oilprice.com, ~11-min delay **(not an ICE/NYMEX settle)**. Spread ~$13.20.
Treasury 2Y/10Y/30Y	4.61% / 4.94% / **not confirmed as of press time** — tradingeconomics.com, Oct. 30 intraday.
DXY	101.64 (-0.39%) — Yahoo Finance, 6:09a ET.
S&P / Nasdaq-100 futures	7,673.25 (-1.04%) / 28,876.25 (-2.32%) — 6:09a ET.
VIX	18.48 (+7.44%) — Yahoo Finance **(page timestamp label internally inconsistent)**
Gold	$3,983.10 (-0.93%) — Kitco, 6:18a ET.
Thu. 10/29 close	Dow 52,342.56 (-0.25%); S&P 500 7,720.39 (-0.30%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,184.73 (-1.38%).
Europe / Asia	FTSE 100 ~10,742-10,743 (+0.18-0.20%); Nikkei 225 ~62,900-63,300 (-2.1% to -2.7%)

	(tradingeconomics.com, CFD-sourced and internally inconsistent)
Retail gas (AAA natl.)	$4.2046/gal (10/30), down from Thu.'s $4.2258 — third straight decline [DEVELOPING].

Futures and Thursday's close both moved against Wednesday's levels on Amazon's print; see Lead. 30Y yield untracked this run rather than carried stale.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, 30 OCT 1017Z (6:17A ET)

Transits	2 vessels, Oct. 25 (~2% of 85/day baseline) — IMF PortWatch, 5 days stale.
Dark tankers, 24h	41 of 99 screened (41.4%) vs. yesterday's 46 of 182 (25.3%) **[screened sample roughly halved — read as noise]**
War-risk premium	~32.0x pre-crisis — Oct. 7 estimate, 23 days stale; background only.
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±11 (Extreme, flat 24h); Escalation Forecast 60±11 (High, -1 pt).
Closure status	Day 243, per straits.live's transit framing.

Dark-tanker swing coincided with a much smaller screened sample — treated as statistical noise, not a reversal of the drop flagged in the prior issue. See Iran & Hormuz.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Season over (eliminated Oct. 7); no new moves.
Knicks	No reported trades or signings in the last 24 hours; at Philadelphia tonight.
Northwestern	No reported moves; at Oregon Saturday.

LEAD

EARNINGS & CAPEX

Amazon closes the hyperscaler earnings arc with a miss on guidance, not growth — and the market keeps punishing capex uncertainty over beats

Thursday night closed the three-day run of mega-cap tech earnings this brief has tracked since Wednesday, and Amazon's print extended the same divide rather than resolving it. The setup already looked

fragile: Thursday's regular session closed lower across the board — Dow -0.25%, S&P 500 -0.30%, Nasdaq Composite -1.38% — before Amazon's numbers landed after the bell. [fact, NEW] AWS revenue rose 39% year-over-year to $45.98 billion [fact, NEW] — the unit's fastest growth in roughly five years and above the Street's ~37.5% estimate, putting its annualized exit run-rate near $184 billion — with CEO Andy Jassy guiding AWS growth above 40% in both 2027 and 2028 on the call. [fact, NEW] But total revenue of $201.94 billion missed the $202.22 billion consensus narrowly, and EPS of $1.89 missed the $1.97 estimate by roughly 4%. [fact, NEW] Q4 revenue guidance of $240 billion-$247 billion came in, by multiple trackers' reckoning, largely below estimates. [fact, NEW] The stock, which had already closed Thursday's regular session down 4.25% at $243.79 ahead of the print, fell further to $226.65 in Friday premarket trading as of 6:19a ET — down roughly 7% from Thursday's close, though other after-hours snapshots taken at different reference times showed moves ranging from about -6% to -9%, a spread this brief reports rather than compresses into one number. [fact/flag, NEW]

Read: the reaction completes a pattern flagged in Wednesday's issue. Microsoft beat on revenue and EPS, spent less capex than its own guide, and rose after hours. Alphabet beat on revenue, more than doubled its capex, watched Search deceleration swallow the headline, and fell about 10.5%. Amazon now sits in between — its core growth engine, AWS, accelerated and beat, which is the Microsoft pattern, but a soft Q4 guide produced something closer to the Alphabet reaction. [read] The common thread across three different companies' prints this week: the market is no longer rewarding revenue beats on their own; it is pricing each hyperscaler on whether its

forward guidance credibly reconciles growth with the scale of AI capital spending already committed. [read]

That reaction landed hours after a macro backdrop that, on its own, argued for calm. The BEA's Q3 advance GDP estimate came in at +3.4% annualized [fact, NEW] — above the ~3.2% consensus and up sharply from Q2's final 2.2%, though below the Atlanta Fed's ~3.6% GDPNow nowcast. Weekly jobless claims for the week ended Oct. 24 fell to 194,000, below the ~199,000 Reuters poll consensus, with Reuters describing the level as near a 57-year low. [fact, NEW] Neither print moved futures positively Friday morning: S&P 500 futures were down 1.04% and Nasdaq-100 futures down 2.32% as of 6:09a ET [fact, NEW] — a decline this brief reads as Amazon- and tech-earnings-driven, not a reassessment of the broader economy, since the macro data itself came in firm. [read]

Second-order consequence: with Microsoft, Alphabet and Amazon all now reported, the quarter's verdict is a sector-wide one rather than a single-stock data point — capital discipline gets rewarded, capital-spending uncertainty gets punished, regardless of whether the underlying growth engine is actually accelerating, as AWS's plainly is. [read] That verdict lands as this brief could not independently reconcile secondary sources' estimates of CME's implied odds of a Dec. 9 rate hike closely enough to print a number this run [flag] — sharpening, rather than resolving, the question of whether a firm GDP print and a resilient labor market give the Fed room to hold its hawkish line even as the AI-capex trade wobbles. Watch: the regular session open for whether the premarket tech selloff holds; Meta's position as the one major hyperscaler not tested this window against the same guidance bar; and Tuesday's midterms, now four days out, as the next scheduled catalyst.

POLITICS

Four days to the midterms. House control remains a clear Democratic favorite across prediction markets — a range of 81¢-88¢ depending on venue, with Action Network and Polymarket/Kalshi mirrors via 270ToWin among the sources cited [fact, NEW] — while the Senate stays close to a coin flip, cited variously from 51¢ Republican/48¢ Democratic to roughly 52% Democratic depending on snapshot, a spread wide enough that this brief won't average it. [fact/flag] The width of that Senate spread is itself the story: no single venue commands enough consensus this week to treat any one number as the market's view, a contrast with the House figure's relative convergence. [read] On approval, a correction: the only Reuters/Ipsos figure independently corroborated this run is the Oct. 19 poll (fieldwork Oct. 16-19, n=1,679, ±2 pts), showing Trump approval at 31%, disapproval at 66% — a record low for either term. [fact] The "32%" figure some outlets carried this week traces to a tracker entry with the identical 1,679 sample size as the Oct. 19 poll, which this brief now reads as a duplicated data point rather than a fresh survey, and is dropping rather than carrying forward as DEVELOPING. [flag, continuity] Michigan, Texas and North Carolina remain the most-cited battlegrounds, still unranked background color.

ECONOMICS

Beyond the Lead's framing: the BEA's Q3 advance GDP print also showed the gross domestic purchases price index slowing to 3.0% from Q2's 5.6%, and real final sales to private domestic purchasers — a measure of underlying private demand — accelerating to 4.9% from 4.6%. [fact, NEW] The agency noted part of the investment-

and-consumption pickup reflects lower SPR drawdowns mechanically boosting measured activity versus Q2, a methodological point worth weighing against the headline number. [fact/read, NEW] On claims: the prior week (ended Oct. 17) was revised up slightly to 195,000 from an originally reported 194,000, and continuing claims for that same week fell 21,000 to 1.701 million. [fact, NEW] On an unadjusted basis, initial claims for the week ended Oct. 24 ran 178,851, up 5,648 week-over-week but well below the year-ago comparable week's 203,012 — a different series than the seasonally-adjusted headline, included here for the year-over-year comparison it allows. [fact, NEW] The next GDP release — the second estimate, with corporate profits — is Nov. 25; the next claims report is Nov. 5. CME's implied odds of a Dec. 9 hike could not be reconciled across sources this run and are not printed as a number — see Lead. [flag, continuity]

BUSINESS

Beyond Amazon's headline numbers in the Lead: its advertising segment grew revenue to roughly $19.6 billion, +12% year-over-year — decelerating against AWS's 39% but still among Amazon's fastest-growing non-cloud lines by most trackers' reckoning. [fact, NEW] One secondary source put company-wide operating margin at 13.9%, a reported all-time high; this brief flags that figure as single-sourced, having not independently confirmed it against Amazon's own investor-relations release, which wasn't separately fetched this run. [flag, NEW] AAA's national retail gas average fell to $4.2046/gal Friday, a third consecutive recorded decline from Tuesday's $4.2661 and Thursday's $4.2258. [fact, DEVELOPING] Heading into Thursday's print, pre-earnings coverage had Amazon guiding full-year 2026 capital expenditure to roughly $220 billion to support AI

and cloud infrastructure; this brief could not confirm this run whether Thursday's call updated that figure, and flags it as pre-earnings guidance rather than a number restated on the call. [flag] This brief did not independently verify a forward earnings calendar for the next 10 days this run, given the bulk of mega-cap tech reporting has now cleared with Microsoft, Alphabet and Amazon; treat the earnings calendar as not verified this run until the next issue.

TECHNOLOGY

The capex-versus-guidance divide that has defined this week's hyperscaler earnings (see Lead) now has three data points instead of two, and the pattern holds: Microsoft's capex discipline was rewarded, Alphabet's capex doubling was punished, and Amazon's accelerating-but-guidance-light combination produced a reaction closer to Alphabet's than Microsoft's. [read] AWS's guide — growth above 40% in both 2027 and 2028, per Jassy — is the most aggressive forward cloud-growth claim of the three companies' calls this week, and sets a high bar this brief will track against actual prints. [read] Lined up against Wednesday's numbers, the three clouds now show a wide growth spread at wildly different scales: AWS at 39% off a ~$184 billion run-rate, Azure at 48% in constant currency off a smaller base, and Google Cloud at 103% off the smallest base of the three — a reminder that the raw growth-rate comparison this brief has leaned on all week flatters whichever cloud started smallest. [read] No frontier AI model release, major funding round, or orbital launch surfaced as new in this run's research, consistent with the prior two issues; this brief isn't padding the section with stale items already covered.

straits.live's dark-tanker screen swung back up overnight: 41 of 99 screened vessels ran dark in the latest 24-hour window (41.4%), against yesterday's 46 of 182 (25.3%). [fact, NEW] The screened sample size nearly halved between reads, which this brief treats as the more significant number — a swing of this size on a shrinking sample is consistent with noise in a low-traffic environment, not a reversal of the de-escalation signal flagged, and discounted, in yesterday's issue. [read] IMF PortWatch's transit count remains unchanged at 2 vessels on Oct. 25, against the 85/day pre-crisis baseline, and is now five days stale. [fact, continuity] The composite indices barely moved: Crisis Pressure held at 88 (Extreme), and the Escalation Forecast eased one point to 60 (High). The war-risk premium figure (~32.0x pre-crisis) is now 23 days stale and carried for background only. [flag, continuity]

This brief could not reconfirm yesterday's reported UKMTO advisory on an early-Thursday vessel fire off Oman against UKMTO's own advisory text this run; the closest dated UKMTO-linked incidents found were an Oct. 21 projectile-strike-and-fire report off Oman and a separate Oct. 26 fire near the Iraqi coast, neither of which cleanly matches the specific claim carried yesterday. [flag] Pending clearer primary confirmation, this brief is not repeating that item as established fact. No new Iranian state-media claims surfaced in this run beyond what prior issues already carried; this brief treats that absence as "nothing new found," not as confirmation that nothing happened. [flag] Separately, one industry tally circulating this week claims UKMTO has issued a maritime warning every day this month — 13 total — a volume figure this brief has not indepen-

dently verified against UKMTO's own advisory archive and is flagging as single-sourced rather than printing as confirmed. [flag, single-sourced] Methodology note, as always: PortWatch's lagged transit count, straits.live's dark-tanker screen and the war-risk premium measure different things over different windows and are never averaged or differenced here.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over; eliminated Oct. 7, swept 3-0 by Tampa Bay in the ALDS. No new moves.
Knicks	0-3 (last confirmed record); at Philadelphia tonight, 7:30p ET.
Northwestern	6-1 (3-1 Big Ten); no game since Oct. 24's win over Rutgers; at Oregon Saturday, first-ever meeting.

Continuity. Geopolitics (Russia-Ukraine) cut again — no dated, verifiable development surfaced this run. Watch for next issue: the regular session's reaction to the Amazon/tech selloff; whether straits.live's dark-tanker reading stabilizes with a larger screened sample; a primary UKMTO confirmation (or correction) on the Oman-area fire; CME FedWatch's Dec. 9 odds once sources reconcile; tonight's Knicks game and Saturday's Northwestern-Oregon kickoff; and three days to the midterms by Monday.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Brent/WTI (delayed quotes, not confirmed settles); the 30Y Treasury yield (not confirmed as of press time); VIX's page timestamp; Nikkei 225 and FTSE 100 levels (internally inconsistent, CFD-sourced); CME FedWatch's Dec. 9 hike odds (not printed, sources unreconcilable); Amazon's 13.9% operating-margin figure and its exact after-hours stock move (range -6% to -9% depending on reference time); the Knicks' current record (carried forward from the last confirmed reading, not independently reconfirmed this run); and yesterday's UKMTO Oman-fire claim (not reconfirmed against a primary source this run). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.